

## Topic 6: Criminal psychology – Why do people become criminals?

| Subject content                | What students need to learn:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
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| <b>6.1 Criminal psychology</b> | <p>6.1.1 Understand learning theories as an explanation of criminality, including strengths and weaknesses of each theory:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Operant Conditioning (Skinner, 1948), to include               <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>a. positive reinforcement</li> <li>b. negative reinforcement</li> <li>c. positive punishment</li> <li>d. negative punishment</li> <li>e. primary reinforcers</li> <li>f. secondary reinforcers</li> </ol> </li> <li>• Social Learning Theory (Bandura, 1977), to include               <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>g. role models</li> <li>h. modelling</li> <li>i. identification</li> <li>j. observational learning</li> <li>k. vicarious reinforcement</li> </ol> </li> </ul> |
|                                | <p>6.1.2 Understand biological explanations of criminality, including personality types (Eysenck, 1964), to include strengths and weaknesses of the theory:</p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>a. extraversion</li> <li>b. introversion</li> <li>c. neuroticism</li> <li>d. psychoticism</li> </ol>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|                                | <p>6.1.3 Understand the effects of punishments on recidivism, including strengths and weaknesses of each punishment:</p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>a. prison</li> <li>b. community sentencing</li> <li>c. restorative justice</li> </ol>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

| Subject content | What students need to learn:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
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|                 | <p>6.1.4 Understand <b>two</b> treatments to rehabilitate and reduce criminal and antisocial behaviour and increase pro-social behaviour, including strengths and weaknesses of each treatment:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>a. token economy programmes</li> <li>b. anger-management programmes</li> </ul> |